There exist farmans that demonstrate Akbar's interest in the site considered the yogapitha or centre of Brindavan, at which Raja Man Singh began building works for a large new temple at Brindavan in 1590. This temple, like others in the area, became replicas in miniature of the Mughal court. The naubat[*] performed here as it did at the royal palace and indeed as it did at the Ajmer dargah. Statues of the deities Krishna, Balram, and Radha were presented to devotees at set times, like a royal darshan. In building the Govind Deva temple, which then adopted these 'imperial' practices, the raja was not only proclaiming his own stature as a Hindu Kachhwaha raja whose watan jagir was at nearby Amer, but was also visibly celebrating Mughal imperial grandeur in a way that had the Padshah's blessing.

Historian Catherine Asher has shown that there were many unique features in the Govind Deva temple that Raja Man Singh built at Brindavan, reflecting the eddying and swirling currents that increasingly bound together Rajput and Mughal aesthetic values. The temple was never completed, according to the *Jahangirnama*, so lacks a superstructure, though later accounts erroneously claim it was desecrated by Aurangzeb.[†] At nearly 80 metres in length, the temple is by far the largest constructed in north India after the thirteenth century, and the dressed red sandstone used in the temple is typical of Muslim-sponsored architecture. While the temple's exterior is largely aniconic (without idols), the interior has figures associated with Krishna lore—gopis, Radha, cows, etc. Asher further points out that while Raja Man Singh used classically Mughal arcuated, domed, and vaulted interior corridors flanked by bracketed pillars, the manner in which the temple used long barrel vaults, domes, and intersecting vaults to create a sense of arcing space and expansive grandeur actually anticipated trends in Mughal architecture, making Raja Man Singh something of a visionary and trendsetter. So admired was this temple that Abdu'l Latif, visiting in the seventeenth century, wished that it were a mosque and not a temple.

The inscriptions on the temple are eloquent in demonstrating the rising status of the Kachhwaha clan within the Mughal Empire. This is the earliest inscription from Man Singh's reign and claims for him a title greater than that used for his father and grandfather. Historian Ramya Sreenivasan has shown that the Brajbhasha inscription accords Man Singh the title Maharajadhiraja whereas his father had only been accorded the status of